



Henpecking is a common problem among chickens.

1903 Chicken glasses

American Andrew Jackson (no relation to the president!) developed **protective glasses** for his feathered friends to wear to stop them from hurting each other's eyes. Jackson assumed his **sight-saving invention** would provide a good nest egg, but it's a mistake to count your chickens before they hatch. Although some glasses were sold at the turn of the century, they are now **nowhere to be seen**.

1922 Baby cage

For nannies left holding the baby in high-rise buildings, one last resort was **an outdoor cage** where you could put a baby. American inventor **EMMA READ**'s intentions were good: The plan was to give babies **fresh air and room to play**. In reality, though, there was a lot of rattling of cages and baby blues all around.

1960 Smell-o-Vision

American movie maestro Mike Todd, Jr., believed he was on to the **sweet smell of success** with Smell-o-Vision. This new technology released odors during the showing of films to enhance the experience. **Scent of Mystery** was the only film to use Smell-o-Vision, and it was an absolute stinker. Audiences turned their noses up at the gimmick and Todd had to wake up and smell the coffee.

1962 Robot Readamatic

This robotic reading device was designed to speed up bookworms. At the **turn of a dial**, one line of text was displayed at a time. Although meant to increase the reader's pace, the design was **FATALLY FLAWED**, since the machine's loud whirring sound and distracting mechanical arm had users throwing the book at the invention.

1976 Rolling ball

Italian **ALESSANDRO DANDINI** came up with a bizarre new vessel for transporting cargo across the sea. He devised a plan to use **a big motorized ball** with two cabins attached to either side. Cargo could be stored inside the sphere or the cabins. However, the tipping point came when one cabin was detached, causing the whole craft to **flip on its side**. As a result, the marine machine didn't make its rounds for long.

1980s Nimslo 3-D camera

The combined efforts of American photography enthusiasts Jerry Nims and Allen Lo produced the Nimslo 3-D camera. The **snap-happy device** used four lenses, each taking one frame at a slightly different angle to make one 3-D image. Unfortunately, the creators hadn't focused on the bigger picture. At **TEN TIMES THE PRICE** of a normal camera, consumers said no to Nimslo.

1982 APT

The Advanced Passenger Train was designed to tilt as it traveled around corners, but the idea **went off the rails** from the get-go. All the tipping and dipping at high speeds had passengers reaching for sick bags, frozen brakes posed a problem in cold spells, and some parts of the design got stuck at a slant! The tilting train was **GOING NOWHERE**.

2007 Phone Fingers

When Austrian **PHILIPP ZUMTOBEL** pointed a finger at the problem of smudges and marks on smartphones, his solution took the form of an accessory called Phone Fingers. These tight-fitting **rubber finger covers** are rolled onto the user's digits to keep keypads clean. However, the public gave the idea a **thumbs down**—most phone users fixed the original problem by simply washing their hands.

Phone Fingers were too difficult to get on and off.

